

Apple's attention to detail is stuff of legend. There's an enthusiasm to go overboard for marginal improvements. The late Steve Jobs famously commented, "when you're a carpenter making a beautiful chest of drawers, you're not going to use a piece of plywood on the back." This man's direction has been largely responsible for the design direction and the penchant for beauty that Apple is known for.

Yeah, we get it. Most of us don't need beauty, we need a functional machine that doesn't bankrupt us. But maybe having an open mind isn't so bad - in fact, maybe it's important. And that's what this FastTrack is about.

Whether or not you actually go for any of their products by the time you reach the end of this book is irrelevant. What's more important is that there's something to learn from Apple for everyone. If you're a loyal customer, order another latte from that place we *know* you're sitting at, and reveal a few minute details in your own product that you quite possibly didn't know about. But if you are an Apple Outsider this FastTrack will be the perfect window into an ecosystem we know you've been (*perhaps secretly*) curious about.

It's a two part special which will run over the course of two consecutive months and aims to give you an insight into Apple's products both from the hardware and software perspective. This part 1 deals mainly with the hardware and specifications of your favourite Apple devices. Nevertheless, talking about hardware in isolation is sacrilege in today's world, especially when it comes to Apple; hence wherever the two are inextricably interlinked we've covered both sides of the ecosystem. Of course it goes without saying we've saved some of the best stuff for part 2 so stay tuned for next month. Until then happy reading. 